WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital

UNITED STATES

North America

Information current as of November 2026

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
New York	The world's leading financial centre and home to the deepest capital markets, global banks and asset managers	Financial services, professional services, media, technology
Texas and the Gulf Coast	Energy and petrochemical heartland; the $2.1 billion GulfLink deepwater crude export terminal is in the first tranche of Japan's $550 billion investment pledge	Oil and gas, LNG, petrochemicals, ports and logistics
Ohio and the Midwest	Industrial base and a leading destination for semiconductor construction; site of a planned 9.2 GW gas-fired power plant worth about $33 billion led by SoftBank's SB Energy	Advanced manufacturing, semiconductors, power generation, automotive
Arizona and the Mountain West	One of the largest centres of new semiconductor fabrication investment, alongside Idaho	Semiconductors, electronics, data centres, renewables
California and the Pacific Northwest	Global centre for technology, artificial intelligence and venture capital	AI and software, life sciences, clean technology, entertainment
The South-East (Georgia, the Carolinas, Tennessee)	Fast-growing manufacturing corridor with competitive costs; Georgia will host a $600 million synthetic diamond plant under the Japan investment pledge	Automotive and batteries, advanced materials, logistics
Washington, DC	Seat of the federal government, regulators and Congress, central to trade, CFIUS and incentive matters	Government relations, defence, professional services

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- SelectUSA, the federal investment promotion programme within the Department of Commerce, connects investors with federal agencies and state economic development organisations; its May 2026 Summit drew more than 5,500 attendees and over $56 billion in investment commitments
- CFIUS national-security review of foreign acquisitions in critical technology, infrastructure, sensitive data and real estate; Treasury is designing a Known Investor Program to speed reviews for trusted allied investors
- Semiconductor incentives: the advanced manufacturing investment credit rose to 35% for property placed in service after 2025, for projects where construction begins by 31 December 2026

- Energy tax credits for nuclear, storage, geothermal, carbon capture and clean fuels continue on phased timetables, while wind and solar credits now require construction to have begun by 4 July 2026 or service by end-2027
- State-level incentives such as tax abatements, tax increment financing, enterprise zones, grants and workforce training, negotiated directly with state and local development agencies
- Fully convertible US dollar with no capital controls, open capital markets and strong legal protection for investors
- Foreign-Trade Zones, allowing duties to be deferred or reduced on imported components used in US production

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

The United States in November 2026 remains the world's largest destination for foreign direct investment, combining unmatched market scale, deep capital markets and technology leadership. Real GDP grew at an annual rate of 3.4% in the third quarter of 2026, up from 2.2% in the second, led by investment, consumer spending and government spending. New foreign direct investment rose 49.5% to $232.2 billion in 2025, led by investors from Japan ($50.5 billion), Germany ($26.7 billion) and Canada ($23.5 billion). Strategic partners are adding further capital: Japan's $550 billion investment pledge launched its first $36 billion tranche in February 2026, focused on energy and industrial projects. Federal incentives for semiconductors, nuclear, storage and advanced manufacturing, together with competitive state packages, continue to support large-scale industrial investment.

The main challenge for investors is policy volatility, particularly in trade and monetary conditions. The Supreme Court ruled in February 2026 that tariffs could not be imposed under emergency powers, and the administration has since rebuilt its tariff regime under other trade laws, including Section 301 tariffs of 10–12.5% on 60 economies from July 2026 alongside sector tariffs on steel, aluminium, autos and other goods. Inflation rose to 3.7% in September 2026, driven by energy prices up 20.4%, and the Federal Reserve under Chair Kevin Warsh raised rates in September to a 3.75–4% range. Investors can mitigate these pressures by producing locally, which avoids import tariffs and positions firms to benefit from strong domestic demand, and by securing incentives early. The Democratic victory in both chambers of Congress in November 2026 is likely to bring more legislative scrutiny of trade policy from January 2027, adding a further check on future changes.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Tariff and trade-policy changes	Section 301 tariffs of 10–12.5% on 60 economies apply from 24 July 2026, while Section 232 tariffs apply to steel, aluminium, autos and other sectors, raising input costs	Localise production and supply chains, use Foreign-Trade Zones, check eligibility for exemptions and model tariff scenarios
CFIUS and national-security review	Acquisitions involving critical technology, infrastructure, sensitive personal data or sensitive real estate may require a filing and mitigation measures	Assess CFIUS jurisdiction early, structure deals with experienced counsel and monitor the Known Investor Program for faster reviews
Outbound investment rules	The COINS Act of December 2025 codified outbound rules; an October 2026 proposal would extend them beyond China to Russia, Iran, North Korea and Cuba and to new sectors	Investors with US parents or partners should map exposure to covered sectors and countries and take compliance advice
Inflation and interest rates	Inflation of 3.7% in September 2026 and a September rate rise have lifted financing costs, with markets watching for a further increase	Lock in long-term financing, use state and federal incentives, and build higher energy and labour costs into plans
Incentive deadlines	The 35% semiconductor credit requires construction to begin by end-2026, and wind and solar credits have tightened	Accelerate project timelines and confirm eligibility, including foreign-entity rules, with tax advisers
Public finances	The Congressional Budget Office projects a fiscal 2026 deficit of $2.1 trillion, partly reflecting about $100 billion of tariff	The dollar's reserve-currency role and deep Treasury market support financing; monitor tax and spending policy in the new

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
	refunds	Congress
Regulatory complexity	Federal, state and local rules overlap on permitting, labour, environment and tax	Work with state development agencies and local advisers, and choose states whose regime suits the project

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

The United States offers investors the strongest rule of law, the deepest capital markets and the largest consumer market in the world, with growth of 3.4% in the third quarter of 2026. The main risks are policy-driven. After the Supreme Court struck down emergency tariffs in February 2026, about $100 billion has been refunded and replacement tariffs under Sections 301 and 232 now apply, with further legal challenges pending; investors should plan for tariff scenarios and favour local production. Inflation of 3.7% and the Federal Reserve's September rate rise point to higher financing costs in the near term. CFIUS reviews and expanding outbound-investment rules are legal requirements that call for early specialist advice, although allied investors are explicitly welcomed. The Democratic majorities elected to Congress in November 2026 will take their seats in January 2027, which may increase oversight of trade and economic policy and create a more balanced legislative environment.

MARKET ACCESS

The United States is a founding member of the WTO and is linked to Canada and Mexico through the United States–Mexico–Canada Agreement (USMCA), which remains in force until 2036 after the first joint review in July 2026, with annual reviews to follow; USMCA-qualifying goods are exempt from the July 2026 Section 301 tariffs. Since 2025 the administration has concluded investment and trade arrangements with partners including Japan, whose $550 billion pledge directs capital into US energy, infrastructure and manufacturing, while the EU, Taiwan, Japan, South Korea and Switzerland have capped Section 301 rates. A US base gives investors direct access to the world's largest consumer market, an integrated North American supply chain and an extensive network of ports, rail and air links.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
The White House (President Donald Trump)	Sets trade, tariff and industrial policy, and directs investment arrangements with partner countries	Primary reference point for strategic policy direction
SelectUSA (Department of Commerce)	Federal investment promotion programme; runs the annual Investment Summit, next on 2–5 May 2027	Standard first point of contact for market entry and state introductions
Committee on Foreign Investment in the United States (CFIUS, chaired by Treasury)	Reviews foreign investments for national-security risk and administers outbound investment rules through Treasury	Essential for structuring acquisitions and sensitive-sector investments
Federal Reserve (Chair Kevin Warsh)	Sets the federal funds rate, now 3.75–4% after a September 2026 increase, and supervises major banks	Key reference for financing costs and the dollar outlook
Office of the US Trade Representative (USTR)	Leads Section 301 actions, USMCA reviews and trade negotiations	Relevant for tariff exposure, exclusions and trade-agreement developments
Congress (120th Congress from January 2027)	Democrats won majorities in both the House and Senate in November 2026, with oversight of trade, tax and spending	Important for the outlook on tariffs, tax credits and appropriations
State economic development agencies	Negotiate site selection, tax abatements, grants and workforce support for individual projects	Central counterparts for incentive packages and local permitting

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

SelectUSA's annual Investment Summit, held in National Harbor, Maryland, is the main federal forum for foreign investors, bringing together economic development organisations from all 55 US states and territories. Bilateral chambers such as the British American Business Council, the German American Chambers of Commerce and the Japan External Trade Organization's US offices support investors from their home countries, while the US Chamber of Commerce and the National Association of Manufacturers represent business at federal level. State development agencies and regional bodies provide direct site-selection support, and foreign embassies' commercial sections in Washington offer introductions.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

The United States suits investors seeking scale and long-term growth: manufacturers localising production to serve the US market and reduce tariff exposure; semiconductor, energy and advanced-manufacturing investors able to secure federal credits and state packages before deadlines; infrastructure and power investors meeting rising demand from data centres and industry; and technology, life sciences and financial-services firms drawing on US talent and capital markets. Investors in sensitive technologies should plan for CFIUS review from the outset.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage SelectUSA and shortlist states
Use SelectUSA to reach state economic development organisations and compare sites, costs, workforce and incentive packages.

STEP 2: Assess CFIUS and outbound-investment exposure
Determine early whether the investment falls within CFIUS jurisdiction or outbound rules, and plan filings and mitigation with counsel.

STEP 3: Model tariff and supply-chain scenarios
Quantify Section 301 and Section 232 exposure, test USMCA qualification and consider Foreign-Trade Zones and local sourcing.

STEP 4: Secure federal and state incentives before deadlines
Confirm eligibility for semiconductor, energy and manufacturing credits, including the end-2026 construction start for the 35% chip credit.

STEP 5: Track the new Congress and monetary policy
Monitor trade, tax and spending changes from January 2027 and Federal Reserve decisions affecting financing costs.